

Chapter 171-1

The next day, before they had even gotten up, the production team had already delivered task cards.

Liang Shi was the type who didn't linger in bed, but Yang Shuyan in the other bed was sleeping soundly. Afraid of disturbing Yang Shuyan, she lay in bed and played on her phone for a while.

It wasn't until she heard movement outside that she got up to check.

The task card had been slipped through the door crack: [Arrive at Room 21 by 7:30. This will determine whether you get to eat breakfast. Please note: Your outfit must include Chinese-style elements.]

The production team had given them advance notice about clothes with Chinese-style elements, so Liang Shi had prepared ahead of time.

But it was already 7:20, and Yang Shuyan still hadn't woken up.

Liang Shi had no choice but to brace herself and wake Yang Shuyan.

"Sister Yan." Liang Shi half-squatted by her bedside and called out softly.

Yang Shuyan's brows furrowed slightly. She turned over and pulled the blanket over her head to continue sleeping.

"Sister Yan, we need to get up for the task." Liang Shi continued calling.

Only then did Yang Shuyan kick off the blanket. Still with her eyes closed, she raised her arm to cover her eyes and kicked her feet twice, looking very impatient.

"What task?" Yang Shuyan's voice was somewhat hoarse.

Liang Shi: "Breakfast task."

Yang Shuyan sat up. Liang Shi thought she had been moved by the mention of breakfast, but instead she asked with complete incomprehension, "Eating breakfast at this hour?"

Liang Shi nodded with a bewildered expression.

Yang Shuyan lay back down again. "I don't eat breakfast."

Liang Shi: "....."

Yang Shuyan had stayed up very late last night, apparently playing games.

When Liang Shi went to sleep, she had seen Yang Shuyan's phone screen still lit up, but she hadn't made any sound and hadn't affected Liang Shi's rest. Liang Shi just said something to her and went to sleep on her own.

By the time Liang Shi went to sleep, it was already past midnight—much later than her usual bedtime.

She couldn't help it; once she started chatting with Xu Qingzhu, she always went overtime.

Yang Shuyan looked like she must have stayed up very late, but still had to force herself to get up and record the show.

However, even after staying up all night, her skin condition was still impressive. She got up and washed her face with cold water, tied her hair up casually, dug out some clothes from her suitcase and changed—the whole process took no more than five minutes.

Liang Shi was still holding her tone-up cream and called out to her, "Aren't you going to put on a base?"

Yang Shuyan shook her head. She was about to speak but yawned first. "Don't you want to eat breakfast? Let's go."

Liang Shi: "....."

Having good looks really let you be willful.

Liang Shi also just casually applied a base and tied her hair into a ponytail. Walking alongside Yang Shuyan, she was not inferior in the slightest.

One could only say each had their own kind of beauty.

When they arrived, only Liang Xinran was there.

She had done a very energetic girl-style makeup, very refined, and was sitting there eating breakfast at a leisurely pace.

Soup dumplings, pork rib soup, and three or four side dishes—it looked very sumptuous.

Seeing them arrive, Liang Xinran smiled and greeted them: "Hello, Sister Yan, A-Shi. I didn't get a chance to chat with you yesterday. It's all because I was too silly yesterday. Sorry about that—you won't hold it against me, right?"

Yang Shuyan paused. "Why would we hold it against you? You couldn't help being sick."

Liang Xinran smiled gracefully. "Sister Yan is so nice."

Her tone was intimate—if you didn't know better, you'd think they had a great relationship.

Liang Shi maintained her distance throughout and didn't speak.

She didn't want to have any connection with Liang Xinran beyond that of strangers.

After Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan arrived, they couldn't just eat breakfast directly—they still had to play a game.

It was a two-person cooperation game called "Point East, Point West."

The production team would pose a question, and the two people had to point in opposite directions.

No conferring allowed, and they couldn't have the same result three times in a row. Best two out of three rounds.

Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan had decent chemistry and barely passed.

The breakfast assigned to them was milk, toast, eggs, and two side dishes.

Afterward, Han Qian and Qiqi arrived one after another. Bai Yu showed up late with a messy bird's nest of hair sticking up everywhere, wearing slippers. After arriving, he first leaned against the wall yawning, without any regard for his image whatsoever.

In the end, all that was left for Bai Yu was a single egg.

Bai Yu frowned. ".....I'm hungry though."

Yang Shuyan gave him her milk and toast.

Bai Yu: "?"

Bai Yu seemed to only notice Yang Shuyan at this moment. His expression turned to horror, and he immediately started fixing his hair. Unexpectedly, Yang Shuyan smacked the back of his head with considerable force—at least the on-site audio equipment picked up the sound.

Everyone: "?"

The on-site staff thought Bai Yu was going to blow up. Who didn't know this young master usually had a bad temper?

Earlier, when Liang Xinran had accidentally scratched him with a tree branch in the wilderness, this young master had given her quite a scolding.

But Yang Shuyan had just smacked him on the head directly...

After a few seconds of silence, Bai Yu looked at Yang Shuyan with an aggrieved expression, his voice sulky: "Sister Yan, what are you doing?"

"Do you not want your career anymore?" Yang Shuyan flicked his forehead again. "You're an idol, you know."

Bai Yu: ".....Okay, okay, I know."

When Bai Yu lowered his head, he made a face at her. When Yang Shuyan saw it, she raised her hand to smack him from a distance, and Bai Yu immediately went quiet as a chicken.

The interaction between the two was quite interesting.

The staff looked like they were shipping it.

Even the director was overjoyed. He had long heard that Bai Yu was most afraid of Yang Shuyan in the entertainment industry, but he hadn't expected it to be like this—you could see the chemistry at a glance.

This segment absolutely had to be edited in! It would definitely generate buzz and become a highlight.

Liang Shi didn't think much of it. She wasn't deliberately creating topics for herself and just diligently completed her tasks throughout.

In the travel segment that followed, they had to search for treasures in various places around the town.

Liang Shi was like a lone wolf—once she got the task card, she went off to do it. She was lucky, and the earlier tasks were all completed smoothly.

When Bai Yu came to team up with her, she readily agreed, though she still asked Bai Yu why he didn't go find Yang Shuyan.

Bai Yu scoffed lightly. "She teamed up with Liang Xinran."

Liang Shi was actually relieved. Having Bai Yu as a partner was much better than having Liang Xinran.

After a day of treasure hunting, Liang Shi and Bai Yu ranked second, while Yang Shuyan's team ranked first.

They had accumulated the highest points and could use them to get extra food at dinner.

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After a day, Liang Xinran appeared to have become quite familiar with Yang Shuyan, but Yang Shuyan maintained her lukewarm demeanor throughout.

There was none of the intimacy she showed when interacting with Bai Yu.

When dinner time came, after they finished eating, they played another game—the classic "Visit Three Gardens."¹

Liang Xinran kept losing in various unexpected places.

In the end, her face was covered with sticky notes, yet she still said to the camera with a smile: "How did this happen?"

The following days were much the same.

Liang Xinran didn't deliberately provoke Liang Shi, but occasionally they would clash in subtle ways—for instance, when competing for tasks or forming teams, Liang Xinran would smile sweetly at her: "A-Shi wants to compete with me again?"

Liang Shi would always yield to her, because she couldn't be bothered to argue with her.

But when it came to matters of winning or losing, Liang Shi wouldn't give an inch.

The production team staff privately nicknamed them "The Battle of the Two Liangs."

Liang Shi didn't take it to heart. She just wanted to finish filming this show as soon as possible.

She really didn't want to see Liang Xinran.

What made Liang Shi particularly uncomfortable was on the evening before the last day of recording.

That day, the tasks ended earlier than usual. Because she and Yang Shuyan were about to leave, the production team had prepared a lavish dinner.

After the tasks ended, everyone had to go get their hair and makeup done. Liang Shi hadn't even brought a styling team—she did everything herself. So she simply braided her hair and did a light, natural makeup look, very much like those "first love" makeup looks popular online.

After finishing her styling, she went to the bathroom. When she came out, she saw Liang Xinran smoking.

Expressionless, her eyes cold, she was exhaling smoke without a trace of emotion. That delicate face carried a hint of world-weariness—different from Zhou Yi'an and Chen Mian's kind. It was a world-weariness tinged with shadow, the corner of her lips slightly curved in faint mockery.

She clearly hadn't said anything yet, but it already made people feel uncomfortable.

Liang Shi went to wash her hands, then dried them at a leisurely pace, completely ignoring her.

Then Liang Xinran stubbed out her cigarette and spoke, her voice somewhat hoarse: "Is it fun to ostracize me?"

Liang Shi's hand-drying motion paused. "What makes you say that?"

"Everyone can see that you don't like me." Liang Xinran's voice dropped lower. "I don't even know what I did. I've been trying to avoid you."

"That's not the case." Liang Shi's tone was cold, distant in every way. "You're overthinking it."

Liang Xinran lowered her eyes. "I know none of you like me. I'm not here to compete with you either. I know I can't compete with you—Big Brother and Second Brother both like you so much."

When she said this, she had no expression, but her voice was full of disappointment.

Liang Shi frowned slightly, sensing something was off. She looked around but didn't see any recording equipment.

Logically, this should be a break period—the staff had all gone to rest, so it shouldn't be a recording.

But if it wasn't being recorded, Liang Xinran's words were too strange.

So Liang Shi raised her guard and said coldly, "I don't know what you're talking about."

"How could you not know?" Liang Xinran laughed softly. "It's just the two of us here. I told Mom that I wanted you to come back, but you seem to have blocked her. Mom was quite hurt. She was sick before, and you didn't come either."

"She probably doesn't want to see me," Liang Shi replied.

"How could that be?" Liang Xinran said. "You two were the ones who lived together for over twenty years. I was just always away. Mom is only good to me because she feels guilty. But she genuinely likes you—otherwise, she wouldn't have always been so good to you. I'm not living at the old mansion now either. If you really don't like it, I can step aside."

"I don't dislike you," Liang Shi said. "Don't overthink it. There shouldn't be any competition between us."

"That's good then." Liang Xinran smiled bitterly. "I thought you had always disliked me."

"Why would you think that?" Liang Shi asked in return.

Liang Xinran paused. "It's just the feeling you give me. You seem to really dislike me—you never look at me when you talk. It's just intuition, I guess. I've always wanted to talk to you, but you..."

"Never mind." Liang Xinran's voice was bitter. "I only entered the entertainment industry to do something I like. I won't compete with you for anything. You don't need to hate me so much."

Liang Shi frowned but didn't deny that she disliked her. She turned and left.

The last day of recording was uneventful.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Visit Three Gardens" (逛三園):** A popular Chinese word association game often played in variety shows. Players take turns naming items that belong to a specific category (like fruits, vegetables, or animals in different "gardens"). Players who hesitate too long or give wrong answers lose and usually face a penalty like having sticky notes stuck to their face.

Chapter 171-3

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After Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan finished recording, they flew back to Haizhou City together.

Liang Shi had told Xu Qingzhu in advance, but Xu Qingzhu had a very important meeting and said she would send her assistant to pick her up. Liang Shi immediately refused. "I can just take a taxi back myself. Besides, I can have Dr. Zhao pick me up—I haven't seen her in a while."

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly. "You two are really like two peas in a pod now."

Liang Shi: ".....Maybe we're friends forged through adversity?"

Xu Qingzhu didn't say anything more and went straight to work.

Liang Shi just told her to take care of her health.

But unexpectedly, before boarding the plane, Liang Shi received a message from Zhao Ying: [Where are you?]

Liang Shi sent her location. Zhao Ying sent her an OK gesture: [Wait there after you get off the plane. I'll come pick you up.]

Liang Shi: [Huh?]

Zhao Ying: [The director of Mo Mo Mo Mo wants to meet you. Let's meet together.]

Liang Shi agreed: [Okay.]

After the plane landed in Haizhou, Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan got off together. Both of them were stunningly beautiful, drawing people's attention all along the way.

Especially Yang Shuyan—she had that appeal to the general public.

But Yang Shuyan's manager and assistant were both quite capable and protected her well.

Liang Shi asked Yang Shuyan where she was going next. Yang Shuyan said expressionlessly, "Home to sleep."

Her manager said helplessly, "You have to meet a director tonight."

Yang Shuyan: "That's tonight's business."

Manager: "....."

Liang Shi bid her farewell, saying they'd see each other next time.

Yang Shuyan took off her sunglasses and asked her, "How are you getting back?"

"Sister Ying is picking me up," Liang Shi said. "I have something to do later."

Yang Shuyan's expression shifted slightly. "She's coming to pick you up?"

Liang Shi nodded. "Mm, she should be arriving soon."

Yang Shuyan: "....."

She put her sunglasses back on but didn't leave.

Before long, Zhao Ying's voice came through: "Xiao Liang."

Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan turned their heads at the same time. Liang Shi pulled her suitcase forward to greet Zhao Ying. "Sister Ying."

"Why are you here too?" Zhao Ying looked surprised at the person behind her, then immediately frowned. "Stay away from my car."

Yang Shuyan: "What should be photographed has been photographed, and what shouldn't be photographed has also been photographed. What are you afraid of?"

Zhao Ying rolled her eyes. "Are you trying to ruin your career?"

Yang Shuyan: "A little scandal won't go that far."

Zhao Ying: "You're still not allowed in my car. I'm not here to pick you up."

Yang Shuyan: "Can't you just give me a ride?"

Zhao Ying: "No."

It was midday, and the sun was scorching. Haizhou was about to enter spring.

The two of them stood there bickering with expressionless faces. Liang Shi was caught in the middle. With a casual glance, she spotted a camera not far away and couldn't help but say, "Sister Ying, Sister Yan, there are paparazzi."

"Isn't that normal?" Zhao Ying shrugged. "Her schedule today is semi-public."

Yang Shuyan frowned. "I'll have someone handle it."

"If you keep dawdling here, they'll have the news article written already. What's the point of handling it then?" Zhao Ying said. "Just stay away from my car."

Yang Shuyan glanced at her, then walked straight to the car and got in.

Zhao Ying & Liang Shi: "....."

Yang Shuyan sat in the back row. Zhao Ying sat in the middle row. After Liang Shi got in, she could only sit in the back row, but Yang Shuyan's expression was too icy.

Liang Shi pressed her brow, cleared her throat softly, then leaned toward Zhao Ying and whispered, "Sister Ying, Sister Yan has something to say to you."

Zhao Ying turned around to look, and her gaze met Yang Shuyan's directly.

"What can't be said out loud?" Zhao Ying asked. "So sneaky."

"Are you sure you want me to say it out loud?" Yang Shuyan looked at her with her arms crossed, her expression cold. "I'm afraid you won't be able to handle it."

Zhao Ying: "....."

Yang Shuyan's eyes were clearly saying—if you don't come over here, I'm going to die of anger.

Zhao Ying didn't want to put Liang Shi in a difficult position, so she simply got up and went to the back row. But just as she stood up, the car shook slightly. Zhao Ying lost her balance and fell toward Yang Shuyan, landing right in her arms.

.....

Liang Shi caught a glimpse from the corner of her eye and immediately turned around to cover her eyes. "I didn't see anything."

The atmosphere became awkward for a moment.

Zhao Ying frowned. "Let go."

Yang Shuyan held onto her and didn't let go. "I didn't expect that after just a few days apart, you'd be this eager."

Zhao Ying gritted her teeth. "Let go."

"You're the one who came to me." Yang Shuyan's face remained expressionless, but her tone was much more relaxed than before, carrying a hint of teasing. "What are you doing later?"

"Meeting a director," Zhao Ying said. "We have a dinner appointment. Weren't you going home to sleep?"

Yang Shuyan: "I'll wait for you so we can go together."

Zhao Ying: "?"

Zhao Ying thought this person had gone crazy. But sitting on her lap was indeed more comfortable than sitting on the car seat, and she couldn't break free anyway, so she couldn't be bothered to struggle anymore.

Liang Shi messaged Xu Qingzhu: [I've been fed dog food, QAQ]

Xu Qingzhu: [Whose?]

Liang Shi: [Sister Ying's.]

Xu Qingzhu: [...I saw the trending search.]

Liang Shi: [?]

Xu Qingzhu sent her a link. The Weibo trending topic was #Yang Shuyan Zhao Ying Airport Confrontation#.

Top celebrities were top celebrities indeed.

The photos had only been posted ten minutes ago, and they were already marked as "explosive" and sitting at number one on trending, with the heat still increasing.

The comment section had already exploded.

[Zhao Ying obviously looks so arrogant and overbearing, yuck]

[Is this what they call enemies on a narrow road? Didn't expect my sis to run into Zhao Ying right after getting off the plane. Bad luck.]

[Have the Yan-dogs¹ all gone crazy? You don't need to step on Sister Ying to promote your Water Empress.]

[Anyone can see that Sister Ying was there to pick up a friend. It's your Water Empress who insisted on coming over. Shameless.]

[.....]

"Water Empress" was the derogatory nickname for Yang Shuyan.

Because Yang Shuyan's achievements were very high but she didn't have that many works that went viral, Zhao Ying's fans called her "Water Empress."²

Meanwhile, Zhao Ying was called "Bad Luck Monster" and "Scam Dog" by Yang Shuyan's fans.

The reason was that whenever Zhao Ying was involved, Yang Shuyan's works would definitely get bad reviews. And whenever Zhao Ying had a work out, she would inevitably be compared unfavorably to Yang Shuyan.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Yan-dogs" (顏狗):** A derogatory term for Yang Shuyan's fans, combining "Yan" from her name with "dog" as an insult. Fan wars in Chinese entertainment often involve such name-calling between rival fandoms.

² **"Water Empress" (水皇):** A mocking nickname implying that Yang Shuyan's achievements or awards are "watered down" or undeserved—suggesting she won them through connections or manipulation rather than genuine talent. "Water" (水) in Chinese internet slang can mean fake, inflated, or unearned.

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Very quickly, the trending searches were dominated by Yang Shuyan and Zhao Ying.

The fans continued to fight.

Yang Shuyan and Zhao Ying both received calls from their managers one after another. Both gave the same response: "Just leave it."

Liang Shi turned around again and glanced at the trending searches.

Mm, online rumors really couldn't be trusted.

Liang Shi messaged Xu Qingzhu with a straight face: [The two of them are... showing off their love as if no one else exists.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Our Teacher Liang has it hard.]

Liang Shi: [Huh?]

Xu Qingzhu: [See no evil.]

Liang Shi: [Okay.]

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Meeting with the director and producer of "*Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*" didn't involve anything else significant. They just chatted casually and asked about Liang Shi's upcoming schedule.

Liang Shi mentioned that she had passed the audition for the second female lead in a historical costume drama, but the filming start date hadn't been set yet.

The director then asked if she would be interested in playing the female lead in *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*—the role that Shu Yi had previously been cast for.

Liang Shi didn't agree immediately, but she politely explained to the director that since she had now signed with an agency and had a manager, she naturally needed to go through her manager to negotiate. But if the timing worked out, she would definitely take the role.

After all, she really liked the script for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*.

Liang Shi had Chang Hui negotiate both dramas, and things went very smoothly.

Since all the arrangements for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* were already in place, they would film that one first. The other drama was still in the process of negotiating for the female lead—it hadn't been decided whether it would be Yang Shuyan or another competitor—so it would take some more time.

This happened to leave Liang Shi time to film *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*.

During this free period, the script for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* had also been revised, so what Liang Shi and Zhao Ying received was the corrected version. It differed somewhat from the original but had become better—especially the character Liang Shi would be playing, which was now more outstanding.

After Liang Shi took on this role, the role she had originally auditioned for became vacant. The director searched for a long time but couldn't find anyone more suitable, so Liang Shi recommended Tang Zui for the part.

Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo had been shelved for too long before. Once filming was confirmed again, all the processes moved quickly—recasting roles, taking costume fitting photos, holding the boot ceremony¹, and the production team officially announcing the cast.

The combination of Liang Shi and Zhao Ying also took everyone by surprise.

After all, Liang Shi was still a newcomer. None of her dramas had aired yet, and her movie hadn't been released either.

Even *Journey of the Heart* hadn't started its promotional announcements—that was just happening these few days.

As soon as the casting news for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* came out, it immediately stirred up a storm online.

[Am I seeing things? Has Zhao Ying fallen so low that she's working with an 18th-tier nobody?]

[Is this to have Zhao Ying boost the company's newcomer? I really don't understand.]

[@Zhao Ying, I thought things would be better after you switched companies. Turns out you're just going to another company to babysit newcomers?]

[This Liang Shi is definitely a resource mooch². I could understand if you replaced Shu Yi with Yang Shuyan, but replacing her with some unknown newcomer?]

[I heard this person also acted in Quella's new movie. Is she really a resource mooch?]

[Anyway, I'm disgusted. @Director, can you please put effort into writing the script and not use your feet to pick actors?]

[.....]

When the latest casting news for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* came out, compared to last time, Liang Shi was criticized much more severely.

Before, because Liang Shi was playing a supporting role, her red dress look had just gone viral, and there was the effect of putting down Chen Liuying, so online reception was overwhelmingly positive.

But now the original female lead Shu Yi had gotten into trouble. Even if she had moral and mental issues, her status and abilities were still there for all to see.

How could this "newcomer" Liang Shi directly take over her position?

There was obviously something wrong!

No other speculation beyond Liang Shi being a "resource mooch."

Liang Shi had no way to defend herself. She was so busy that she only glanced at the trending searches once and then stopped paying attention.

Her time was too tight.

Filming for *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* began, and her scenes increased dramatically—not just the suddenly increased dialogue, but also some dances she had to learn from scratch.

Shu Yi had graduated from a dance academy. Things that had been simple for her were very difficult for Liang Shi.

But Liang Shi had a competitive personality in this regard. Since she had taken on this drama, she would do it well. So she firmly refused to use a body double.

She hired a dance teacher to teach her. She filmed during the day and practiced dancing at night.

Even under this high-pressure environment, she still insisted on going home.

However, *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* was a modern drama. Except for the initial location shots, the rest was all filmed within the city, fairly close to her home—about a half-hour drive.

Xu Qingzhu had told her she didn't need to come back and could just stay at a hotel, but Liang Shi always insisted.

Liang Shi felt that while pursuing dreams was important, family was also important.

She didn't want Xu Qingzhu to be alone at home while pregnant.

Pregnant people were prone to overthinking, and Xu Qingzhu was already a bit sensitive when it came to their relationship. Liang Shi could only do her best to put Xu Qingzhu's mind at ease.

Moreover, after going home, Xu Qingzhu could practice lines with her. Even just casually chatting made Liang Shi feel relaxed.

Even if her body was exhausted, Liang Shi's heart was still at ease.

She didn't feel tired at all.

Acting with Zhao Ying was a very comfortable experience. Liang Shi's acting hadn't reached perfection, but it was quite good for a modern urban drama. Especially since this character was somewhat similar to herself, she played it with ease.

Many scenes were done in single takes, and her scenes with Zhao Ying almost always passed in one go.

In this busy environment, Liang Shi spent about half a month.

During her filming period, *"Let's Go, Right Now"* aired.

Although it was a small variety show, it bought several trending searches on the day it aired.

Most critically, there was the previously unknown Liang Xinran.

Someone with no works suddenly appearing on a variety show alongside some quite famous people raised expectations.

At the same time, some people recognized that Liang Xinran was the person who had been searching for family online before.

The national recognition and goodwill she had accumulated before came in handy now. Everyone rushed to boost her popularity.

Liang Xinran also posted a promotional Weibo.

@Liang Xinran: This is my first time participating in a variety show. I was worried that showing my clumsy self on the big screen would disappoint everyone, but I still mustered up the courage to do it~ I hope everyone won't mind. #Let's Go, Right Now#

At the same time, a small brand under Dongheng—which was also the title sponsor of *"Let's Go, Right Now"*—announced their spokesperson on the same day: Liang Xinran.

Although her situation was somewhat similar to Liang Shi's before, public reception was completely different.

[Didn't someone say before that the family this young lady found was wealthy? Looks like it's confirmed now?]

[What is this wealthy heiress lost and found Mary Sue³ plotline!]

[As everyone knows, this young lady's surname used to be Guo, and she had a hard life. Now she's changed back to her birth family's surname. And the CEO of Dongheng Group's surname is Liang, and this brand is controlled by Dongheng. Think about it. Think carefully.]

[Isn't this just a wealthy heiress coming to play in the entertainment industry? Thank you, miss, for lowering yourself to our level.]

[Does jiejie⁴ still want a wife? I volunteer!]

[.....]

Online, it was almost entirely praise.

Liang Xinran's personal popularity exceeded the show's popularity.

Footnotes:

¹ **Boot ceremony (開機儀式):** A traditional ceremony held at the start of filming a Chinese drama or movie, similar to a "first day of shooting" celebration. It often includes burning incense, prayers for smooth filming, and photo opportunities with the cast and crew.

² **Resource mooch (資源咖):** Chinese entertainment industry slang for someone who gets roles and opportunities not through talent but through connections, money, or powerful backers. It implies they're taking resources that should go to more deserving people.

³ **Mary Sue (瑪麗蘇):** A term for an idealized, often unrealistic female character or storyline, typically featuring a perfect protagonist. Here it refers to the "lost princess reunited with wealthy family" trope common in romance novels.

⁴ **Jiejie (姐姐):** Literally "older sister," but commonly used online as an affectionate term for admired female celebrities, regardless of actual age relationship.

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Amid much anticipation, the show premiered.

As a travel variety show—a relatively uncommon type in the variety market—it brought together a Best Actor, a host, an idol, and an amateur. It was full of highlights.

Especially Bai Yu, who had many fans and many haters, and was inherently controversial.

The production team had invited him precisely to create dramatic moments.

And Bai Yu didn't disappoint. In the very first episode, he clashed with Liang Xinran.

Because Liang Xinran asked him if being on stage was tiring and if he had ever wanted to give up, Bai Yu retorted: "Why don't you try it and find out?"

Liang Xinran's expression immediately changed.

Everyone condemned Bai Yu for his bad temper. Bai Yu's fans: [It's not like this is your first day knowing him.]

Two episodes aired in the first week. Although Bai Yu and Liang Xinran had an unpleasant exchange in the first episode, they were later grouped together for a task, and Liang Xinran helped Bai Yu out of a tight spot.

After she helped him, Bai Yu awkwardly talked to Liang Xinran. Fans edited it into a short video with the caption: The foolish beauty and her tsundere¹ Omega.

Once someone started shipping them, others followed suit, shipping them to death.

The two maintained high popularity, and Liang Xinran and Bai Yu's Weibo accounts interacted to promote each other.

The variety show had a decent opening. The invited guests were quite well-known, so it was considered a minor hit.

Yang Shuyan and Liang Shi appeared at the end of the third episode. In the preview at the end of the second episode, Yang Shuyan was shown, but Liang Shi was pixelated—only her clothes were visible. However, there was a scene of her standing with Bai Yu and Yang Shuyan, leaving suspense. Online, everyone speculated about who it could be.

Some guessed it was Zhao Ying, while others guessed it was one of the CPs who had previously worked with Yang Shuyan.

Opinions varied wildly online.

But Liang Shi didn't have time to deal with any of this. Just filming *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* was exhausting enough. She also took the opportunity to officially announce *Journey of the Heart*.

Gu Yixue posted on Weibo tagging her and Sun Chengcheng, then the *Journey of the Heart* production team released official promotional photos along with copy.

Gu Yixue tagged them all together. The movie's official announcement was done by CP pairing—first her and Sun Chengcheng, then Qi Tang and Tang Zui.

The all-newcomer lineup took everyone by surprise. Some people didn't even know who Gu Yixue was, and the comment section was filled with explanations about Gu Yixue.

Before the official announcement, people didn't quite believe this opportunity was real. But it was about to be released soon, the official photos had just come out, and the movie had already been selected for the Golden Palm's² annual outstanding film.

This was obviously aiming for awards, which raised everyone's expectations to the max.

At the same time, the name Liang Shi trended once again.

Everyone became even more curious about her.

[What exactly is this person's background? How come nothing can be dug up?]

[Which family's heiress is she? Bringing investment to join a project can't even explain this anymore.]

[I really don't understand. Am I the only one who thinks she's just average-looking?]

[...I can understand criticizing her acting, but mocking her looks is unnecessary. She really is one of the top beauties in the industry.]

[Does she even have acting skills? She's only slightly better than Chen Liuying.]

[.....]

The movie hadn't been released, the variety show hadn't aired her episodes, the TV drama hadn't broadcast—yet Liang Shi was already being mocked across the entire internet, criticized until she was full of holes.

Liang Shi was worried Xu Qingzhu would be upset, so she messaged her: [Don't go online these next few days.]

Due to the high filming efficiency, more than half of *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* had been filmed in less than a month.

Liang Shi had also lost a lot of weight, becoming increasingly sharp and capable-looking.

Xu Qingzhu replied: [Too late. I've already seen everything.]

Liang Shi: [...Aren't you just making trouble for yourself for no reason?]

It happened to be evening at that moment. Liang Shi had just finished filming. After the high-intensity shooting, she was actually so tired she didn't even want to move her fingers. She sat in a chair, forcing herself to stay alert while messaging Xu Qingzhu.

Unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu replied: [Teacher Liang, turn around.]

Liang Shi first sent: [Hm?]

Then she followed her words and turned to look.

Xu Qingzhu was already showing, though it wasn't very obvious yet. She wore a loose long dress to hide her belly, holding milk tea and food in her hands, standing backlit and smiling at her.

Liang Shi immediately got up to greet her. Xu Qingzhu walked toward her and stopped a few steps away, holding out the items.

Liang Shi took them. "Why did you come?"

Xu Qingzhu raised her hand and pinched her tired face, then frowned and complained unhappily, "How did you get thinner again?"

Liang Shi said helplessly, "It's only been one day. You noticed again?"

"Of course." Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Forget one day—I can tell even after just a few hours."

Liang Shi: "....."

"You're just teasing me," Liang Shi said. "I ate a lot today."

Xu Qingzhu sat down with her. "But you haven't eaten with me yet."

"If you wanted to eat, you could have just called me. I could have come over after I finished filming," Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu paused slightly. "Our Teacher Liang is already too tired from running around every day. You're already working so hard to earn money and support the family. How could I make you run back and forth?"

Liang Shi: "?"

She felt like something was off about how Xu Qingzhu was talking.

"What's wrong?" Liang Shi broke apart the chopsticks and placed them in front of her, asking softly, "Did something happen?"

At that moment, Liang Shi was half-squatting in front of Xu Qingzhu, looking at her with very serious eyes.

Xu Qingzhu raised her hand and touched her hair. "Teacher Liang, won't you really consider letting me support you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ **Tsundere (傲娇):** A Japanese term commonly used in Chinese internet culture to describe someone who is initially cold, hostile, or aloof but gradually shows a warmer, friendlier side. The word combines "tsuntsun" (aloof) and "deredere" (lovestruck).

² **Golden Palm (金棕榈):** A reference to a prestigious film award. In the story's fictional context, this appears to be an important film festival award similar to real-world awards like the Palme d'Or at Cannes.